

The Survival-Breakdown Model and Standard Theory

A Clarification of the Main Criticisms and a Repositioning of Theoretical Order

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Note on the English Version

The authoritative original version of this paper is the Japanese-language original.

This English version was prepared with AI-assisted translation support because the author is a native speaker of Japanese and not a native speaker of English.

This English version is provided for reference only. It should be treated as supplementary material accompanying the original Japanese paper. In the event of any discrepancy in wording, nuance, or interpretation, the Japanese original shall prevail.

Abstract

This paper organizes the main criticisms that can be anticipated against the Survival-Breakdown Model (SBM), explains why many of them do not amount to decisive objections against its central thesis, and reconsiders the relation between SBM and standard economic theory from the standpoints of theoretical order, the conditions for the constitution of agents, domain, and scope of validity. Even within standard theory, phenomena akin to minimum survival, breakdown, inability to continue, and inability to participate can be described to some extent through minimum-consumption constraints, borrowing constraints, penalty terms, state-dependent utility, and corner solutions. But this does not mean that utility maximization or profit maximization is the first principle for explaining such phenomena. The issue is not what can be written mathematically, but where economic theory ought to begin and what gives theoretical meaning to other concepts prior to them.

This paper presupposes two previously published papers. The first is an integrated foundational paper that presented SBM as a theoretical order in which the conditions for the constitution of agents, survivability, basic feasibility, and continuation precede optimization. The second is a development paper that, on the basis of that foundational theory, repositioned demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics as special cases valid only within operative domains where the prior conditions have been satisfied. The role of the present paper is to build on those two achievements by organizing the principal criticisms directed at SBM and by clarifying, in both a defensive and connective manner, the relation between SBM and standard theory.

The central claim of this paper can be summarized in three points. First, optimization is not abolished, but it is not a first principle. Second, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation precede optimization, equilibrium, price adjustment, and aggregate consistency. Third, even where standard

theory remains valid, it is valid only within domains where the prior conditions are satisfied, and its theoretical status should therefore be understood as that of a conditional and domain-limited lower-order theory.

On this basis, the paper classifies the main criticisms of SBM into distinct logical levels such as representability, subsumability, novelty, disciplinary positioning, and completeness, and shows that many of them do not directly reach the central issue of theoretical order. It then positions SBM not as a simple additional constraint imposed on standard theory, but as a theory that antecedently specifies the conditions for the constitution of agents, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation. Accordingly, the relation between SBM and standard theory should be understood not as one of total replacement, but as one between a theory of prior conditions and a conditional subordinate theory. The conclusion is that SBM is most appropriately understood not as a completed closed system, but as a research program that repositions the starting point of economic theory and reorganizes its domain and order of development.

Keywords

Survival-Breakdown Model; economic agency; theoretical order; economic methodology; standard theory; mainstream economics; domain; scope of validity; general equilibrium; macroeconomics

JEL Classification

B41, B49, D01, D50, E10

Chapter 1. Introduction

Economic theory usually begins from agents who maximize objective functions under constraints. Households maximize utility, firms maximize profit, and from there demand, supply, prices, equilibrium, and aggregate outcomes are derived. This construction is analytically very powerful and remains effective in many domains. But if agents and organizations can enter states of non-survival, breakdown, inability to continue, or inability to participate, then prior to optimization and equilibrium one must ask whether those agents are constituted in theory at all and whether they possess the basic room needed to carry out meaningful action. From this standpoint, the Survival-Breakdown Model (SBM) calls for a reordering of the starting point of economic theory. Economic theory should begin not from optimization or equilibrium, but from the conditions for the constitution of agents, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation.

What this claim puts in question is less the truth or falsity of individual theorems than the order of where theory should begin. Even within standard theory, phenomena akin to subsistence limits, severe distress, breakdown, exit, and inability to continue can be described to some extent through minimum-consumption constraints, borrowing constraints, penalty terms, state-dependent utility, and corner solutions. But it does not follow that utility maximization or profit maximization is therefore the first principle of theory. The fact that a phenomenon can be formally written and the fact that one has the correct starting point for explaining it are different matters. It is precisely this distinction that the present paper addresses. What is decisive for the current SBM discussion is not representability as such, but the explanatory priority of what gives theoretical meaning to other concepts before them.

This paper is positioned on top of two earlier published papers. The first presented the integrated foundational theory of SBM and formulated the conditions for the constitution of agents, survivability, basic feasibility, and continuation as explanatory priority conditions prior to utility maximization and equilibrium.

There, the theoretical order of constitutive conditions, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation/destabilization/termination, and optimization was presented as an integrated order of economic agency. The second paper, taking that basic order as given, reclassified demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics as conditional special cases that depend on the prior layer constituted by the continuation of agents and organizations. In other words, the subject of the second paper was to reposition the three core theories of mainstream economics under SBM.

Against this background, the task of the present paper is to take those two theoretical achievements and, first, to organize the major criticisms directed at SBM by logical level and explain why many of them do not directly overturn the central thesis, and second, to reposition the relation between SBM and standard theory explicitly as one between a theory of prior conditions and a conditional subordinate theory. Accordingly, the subject of this paper is not to repeat the reclassification of demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics itself. What it directly addresses are the objections expected against that reclassification and foundational order - for example, that 'standard theory can already write it,' that 'it merely adds a constraint,' that 'it is obvious,' that 'it is nothing more than a general precondition theory outside economics,' or that 'it is incomplete' - and it clarifies what SBM has shown and what it has not yet shown.

In this sense, the paper is not merely a defensive apology. Rather, its aim is to separate out reactions that tend to blur SBM's central issue and, by distinguishing representability from first-principle status, subsumability from theoretical order, novelty from disciplinary position, and incompleteness from programmatic character, to clarify at what level SBM differs from existing theory and at what level it can connect with it. The fact that standard theory remains valid is not the same thing as saying that it is the first starting point of economic theory. Through this distinction, the paper positions SBM not as a simple external critique of existing theory, but as an internal attempt to redescribe the domain and theoretical order of that theory.

The paper has two aims. The first is to classify the major objections to SBM and to show why many of them do not directly overturn its central thesis. The second is to reposition the relation between SBM and standard theory from the standpoints of representability, first-principle status, domain, and scope of validity. The claim here is not that standard theory should be discarded wholesale. Rather, it is to make explicit the prior conditions under which standard theory is valid and thereby to capture its theoretical position more rigorously. Hence this paper adopts neither the stance that SBM is already a total replacement system nor the stance that it should be undervalued as a peripheral amendment. SBM should be understood as a theory that antecedently specifies the conditions for the constitution of agents, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation, while standard theory should be understood as a conditional subordinate theory operating on that basis.

The structure of the paper is as follows. Chapter 2 states the central thesis of SBM and clarifies what is core and what are implications derived from it. Chapter 3 classifies the major criticisms directed at SBM by logical level, such as representability, subsumability, novelty, disciplinary positioning, and completeness. Chapter 4 examines why those criticisms often fail to reach SBM's central issue. Chapter 5 distinguishes representability from first-principle status and makes explicit that the core problem is one of theoretical order. Chapter 6 positions SBM not as a mere additional constraint but as a theory of the conditions for the constitution of agents. Chapter 7 reorganizes the scope of validity of standard theory and provides its connection to demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics. Chapter 8 positions SBM not as a completed closed system but as a research program, distinguishing what has already been achieved from what remains to be developed. Chapter 9 summarizes the whole argument and concludes on the relation between SBM and standard theory.

In this sense, what the paper presents is neither a view that treats SBM as a merely peripheral modification nor a view that hastily concludes that it is a total replacement system. Rather, the task is to reposition SBM, as

a theory of economic prior conditions, within its relation to standard theory and thereby to establish a logical basis for future lower-level developments.

Chapter 2. The Central Thesis of SBM

In discussions surrounding SBM, what counts as the central thesis and what counts as an implication derived from it are often confused. In particular, in order to respond to reactions such as 'standard theory can already write it,' 'it only adds a constraint,' 'it is obvious,' or 'it is incomplete,' it is first necessary to formulate clearly what SBM itself is claiming. The purpose of this chapter is to organize that central thesis and provide the criteria by which the objections considered later should be assessed.

2.1 What Does SBM Claim?

The most basic claim of SBM is that economic theory should begin not from optimization but from the conditions for the constitution of agents. Standard theory generally begins from already given agents maximizing objective functions under given constraints. But this construction presupposes that the agents are already constituted, survivable, capable of carrying out action, and in a state from which continuation is possible. SBM does not leave this presupposition outside theory; it brings it back to the beginning of theory. That is, it argues that prior to optimization one must ask whether the agent exists as an agent at all, whether it is survivable, whether it possesses a basically feasible set of actions, whether it is capable of continuation, and whether sustainable participation is possible.

In this sense, SBM is not merely a theory for cases with harsh constraints. Its center lies in the claim about order: if economic theory is to discuss meaningful action by agents, it must first establish that the agent is constituted as an agent. The conditions for the constitution of agents here are not limited to individuals. For households, firms, institutions, and broader organizational units as well, there are prior conditions for participating in economic activity, continuing, and responding. SBM is therefore not an auxiliary theory for explaining isolated cases of distress, but a foundational theory that foregrounds the conditions of constitution that economic theory has generally taken for granted.

2.2 The Three Pillars of the Central Thesis

The central thesis of SBM that this paper defends can be summarized in three pillars.

First, optimization is not abolished, but it is not a first principle.

SBM does not claim that utility maximization, profit maximization, equilibrium analysis, or aggregate analysis are meaningless. Rather, it acknowledges that they are effective in limited contexts. But their effectiveness does not mean that they are the starting point of theory. Optimization is meaningful only where the agent is already constituted, survivable, basically feasible, and located within a domain of continuation. Optimization remains, but in the order of theory it comes later.

Second, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation precede optimization, equilibrium, and aggregate consistency.

This is the most important ordering thesis of SBM. Survivability here is not limited to the narrow sense of biological maintenance. It means, more broadly, operability: that agents or organizations possess the minimum margin needed to move into the next period, that they can carry out actions, and that they have not fallen into breakdown, exit, or inability to participate. Where basic feasibility is lost, choices may still be written formally, but the theoretical center is no longer the optimality of choice. Likewise, where continuation is broken, price adjustment, equilibrium conditions, and aggregate consistency are only secondary phenomena resting on an already destabilized base. These conditions are therefore not auxiliary conditions added to later theory, but prior conditions.

Third, standard theory operates only conditionally and only within operative domains where the prior conditions are satisfied.

This point is crucial for positioning SBM without misunderstanding. SBM does not immediately abolish standard theory. Standard theory has analytical force in contexts where constitution, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation are secured. Demand-supply theory may be valid as a theory of local market adjustment, general equilibrium theory as a theory of systemic adjustment, and

macroeconomic theory as a theory of aggregate adjustment. But their validity is not universal; it is limited to domains that have passed prior selection. The theoretical status of standard theory must therefore shift from that of a universal first principle to that of a conditional, domain-limited lower-order theory.

2.3 What SBM Does Not Claim

To clarify SBM's central thesis, it is also necessary to note what it does not claim. First, SBM does not claim that standard theory is wholly incapable of representing survival conditions or breakdown conditions. Minimum-consumption constraints, borrowing constraints, penalty terms, state-dependent utility, and corner solutions can describe certain threshold phenomena even within standard theory. But that fact does not show that utility maximization or profit maximization is the first principle. The issue is not whether representability exists, but what the first question of theory should be.

Second, SBM does not claim to be an already completed and fully closed system. Many lower-order developments remain unfinished, including firm theory, game theory, welfare theory, policy theory, empirical operationalization, and domain-specific formalization. This incompleteness does not invalidate the claim about theoretical order itself, but it does require us to distinguish the skeleton already presented from the parts not yet developed. SBM should therefore be understood not as a completed total system, but as a research program with a clear central core whose further development remains open.

Third, SBM does not make it its primary purpose to deny one by one each theorem or result of standard theory. The issue is less the truth of individual propositions than the order of where theory begins and where it is valid. SBM therefore does not merely discard demand functions, equilibrium conditions, or aggregate equations; it re-specifies the prior conditions under which those things acquire meaning.

2.4 The Theoretical Position of the Central Thesis

Organized in this way, the theoretical position of SBM becomes clear. SBM is not a peripheral amendment to standard theory, but a foundational theory that makes explicit the conditions for the constitution of agents that economic theory has implicitly presupposed and that brings their order to the foreground. At the

same time, SBM is not a purely antagonistic theory standing wholly outside standard theory. It should rather be understood as a theory that antecedently regulates the scope of validity and theoretical order of standard theory. In this sense, the relation between SBM and standard theory cannot be adequately captured by the simple dichotomy of subsumption or exclusion. It is better understood as the relation between a theory of prior conditions and a conditional subordinate theory.

This positioning is also consistent with the view that demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics should be understood as subordinate sequences dependent on the prior layer constituted by the continuation of agents and organizations. The role of this paper is to defend and further reposition that arrangement in relation to mainstream objections.

2.5 Concluding Remarks

This chapter organized the central thesis of SBM into three points: optimization is not abolished but is not a first principle; survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation precede optimization and equilibrium; and standard theory is conditionally valid only within operative domains where the prior conditions are satisfied. It also confirmed that SBM does not claim either that threshold phenomena cannot at all be represented within standard theory or that SBM is already a fully completed closed system. With this, the criteria by which the major objections considered in the following chapters should be evaluated are now clear. The next chapter organizes the principal criticisms expected against SBM.

Chapter 3. Organizing the Major Objections

The objections directed at SBM often appear superficially similar to one another. For example, reactions such as 'standard theory can already write it,' 'it only adds one constraint,' 'it is obvious,' 'it is merely a general conditions theory outside economics,' and 'it is incomplete' all tend to weaken SBM's originality or theoretical standing, and are therefore easily treated as if they were objections of the same type. In fact, however, they belong to different logical levels. One objection concerns the possibility of mathematical representation; another concerns whether SBM can be subsumed within existing theory; another concerns novelty, disciplinary positioning, or completeness as a research program. To discuss SBM accurately, it is therefore necessary first to sort these objections by logical level and make explicit which issue each belongs to.

Before evaluating particular objections, this chapter classifies what they are actually questioning. Its purpose is not to refute them one by one, but to show that debate about SBM is composed of multiple levels.

3.1 Objections Concerning Representability

One of the most common objections is that the phenomena emphasized by SBM - survival, breakdown, inability to continue, and inability to participate - can already be represented within standard theory through minimum-consumption constraints, borrowing constraints, penalty terms, state-dependent utility, and corner solutions. The form of this objection varies, but the substance is largely the same: the phenomena SBM seeks to describe can be accommodated within existing mathematical frameworks, and for that reason SBM is not an independent theory.

What this objection puts in issue is representability in the sense of whether a phenomenon can be written within the existing notation of standard theory. Its main target is therefore the flexibility of mathematical description.

3.2 Objections Concerning Subsumability and Added Constraints

A second important objection is that SBM is, in the end, nothing more than a single added condition or constraint imposed on standard theory. On this view, the basic structure of standard theory is preserved, and if one exogenously adds a minimum survival level, a breakdown threshold, or a continuation constraint, then most of what SBM wants to say can be absorbed. SBM would thus not be an independent theory, but merely an auxiliary extension of existing theory or a special-case specification.

What this objection questions is not mere representability, but subsumability: whether the content of SBM can be repositioned while preserving the basic structure of standard theory. Whereas the debate over representability asks whether it can be written, this objection asks whether it can be recovered within the framework of existing theory.

3.3 Objections Concerning Novelty and Obviousness

A third type of objection says that SBM's claim is too simple, that 'of course no economy is possible if agents are not alive,' or that 'it is all obvious.' This objection does not target the possibility of formal absorption as such; rather, it seeks to diminish the intellectual significance of SBM itself. The claim is that what is being said is intuitively obvious and not enough to warrant calling it a new theory.

What this objection questions is the novelty of the proposition and its theoretical value. Its primary object is therefore not the arrangement of theory itself, but the assessment of intellectual surprise and originality.

3.4 Objections Concerning Disciplinary Position

A fourth objection holds that SBM is less an internal theory of economics than a broader general theory of conditions, or perhaps a philosophical or ontological account of the constitution of agents. On this view, even if what SBM says has some meaning, it is not something to be claimed within economic theory itself, but only a metatheory outside economics or a peripheral background-conditions theory.

What this objection questions is disciplinary affiliation and theoretical positioning. In other words, it asks: the claim may be important, but is it economics proper? Its target is therefore less the content itself than the drawing of disciplinary boundaries.

3.5 Objections Concerning Completeness and Incompleteness

A fifth objection is that SBM remains incomplete and has not been presented as a full theoretical system. It is true that SBM has presented a basic hierarchy, the dynamics of continuation/destabilization/termination, and a partial reclassification of demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics, while still leaving many lower-level developments only partially addressed, such as firm theory, game theory, welfare theory, policy theory, empirical operationalization, and domain-specific formalization. The objection that it is incomplete as a 'new general theory' therefore has some weight.

What this objection questions is completeness as a research program. Even if a central thesis about theoretical order has been presented, how far can it be evaluated as an independent theoretical program so long as it remains insufficiently developed?

3.6 Confusions Among the Objections

As the foregoing shows, the major objections can at least be divided into different levels: representability, subsumability, novelty, disciplinary positioning, and completeness. What matters here is that these objections are often confused with one another. For example, the objection that 'standard theory can already write it' belongs to representability, but it does not automatically lead to the conclusion of subsumability that 'SBM is unnecessary.' Likewise, the objection that SBM is incomplete belongs to completeness, but by itself it does not imply that the central thesis is mistaken. And the objection that SBM lies outside economics concerns disciplinary position, not representability or completeness.

To evaluate criticisms of SBM, one must first make explicit what exactly those criticisms are questioning. Otherwise, 'what can be written' and 'what is the correct starting point,' 'being incomplete' and 'being meaningless,' and 'being a general condition' and 'not being economics' will continue to be conflated.

3.7 Concluding Remarks

This chapter classified the main objections to SBM into different logical levels: representability, subsumability, novelty, disciplinary positioning, and completeness. This makes clear that the objections are not of one piece, but belong to different questions. The next chapter examines how those objections stand in relation to SBM's central issue.

Chapter 4. The Core That the Objections Do Not Reach

The principal objections organized in the previous chapter belonged to different logical levels. This chapter examines how far they actually reach SBM's central issue. The question here is not whether each objection is meaningful, but whether it directly denies the central problem of explanatory priority. In the present manuscript as well, the core of SBM is taken to lie in the order of what economic theory should begin from and what should be placed first in theory.

4.1 The Core Issue Is Not Representability

The most typical objection directed at SBM is that minimum survival, breakdown, and inability to continue can all be represented even within standard theory. This objection appears persuasive because standard theory is formally flexible. It certainly does matter that minimum survival conditions, severe distress, and breakdown can be introduced as subsistence limits, borrowing constraints, severe penalties, or state-dependent utility.

But what follows immediately from that observation is, at most, only that standard theory is flexible. It does not follow that utility maximization or profit maximization is the first principle of theory, nor that the conditions for the constitution of agents are subordinate to it. What SBM asks is not which option yields the highest utility among available alternatives, but whether the agent remains within the survivable region at all. Thus the representability objection looks close to the central thesis, but in fact answers a different question.

Even if a phenomenon can be formally described within standard theory, this does not mean that the theory provides the correct starting point for explaining it. Therefore the objection that 'it can be written' is not a decisive blow against SBM, but only an observation about the flexibility of mathematical representation. To reach the core issue, one would have to go further and show that because it can be written, standard theory ought to begin from optimization. But that reason has not been shown.

4.2 The Core Issue Is Not Whether It Can Be Added, but Whether It Comes First

The objection that 'SBM merely adds a constraint' also often appears powerful. If survival conditions, continuation conditions, and breakdown conditions can be added exogenously to existing objective functions or constraint sets, then SBM seems to be not a new theory but only a special extension of standard theory. But this view also displaces the issue. The problem is not whether a condition can be added afterward, but what that condition is prior to in theory.

From SBM's standpoint, survival conditions are not one further constraint exogenously attached to an optimization problem. They are conditions that antecedently determine whether the agent is theoretically constituted at all. When an agent is in a state of breakdown, the theoretically meaningful question is not which option yields higher utility, but how survival conditions can be restored. Survival and continuation conditions are therefore not subordinate elements written inside an optimization problem. They are prior conditions that determine whether the optimization problem has meaning in the first place.

In this sense, the objection that SBM 'only adds a constraint' may not actually succeed in absorbing SBM into standard theory; it may merely restate SBM's claim in the language of standard theory. Even where the same state of affairs can be represented mathematically, its theoretical status need not be the same. The issue, therefore, is not addability but priority.

4.3 The Objection That It Is 'Obvious' Is Not a Core Objection Either

Objections such as 'of course economic activity is impossible if agents are not alive,' 'SBM is too simple,' or 'it is only stating the obvious' are also common. Such reactions seek to diminish the theoretical importance of SBM, but if one looks carefully at their structure, they too do not directly deny the central thesis. A proposition's appearing intuitively obvious is different from its being placed in the correct position within a theory.

Conditions that ought to be placed at the starting point of theory are especially liable to appear obvious from everyday intuition. But what appears obvious is not thereby already properly foregrounded in theory.

What SBM is questioning is not whether something is common sense, but whether that condition has been theorized prior to optimization and equilibrium. The objection that it is obvious therefore does not evaluate the theoretical position of the claim.

4.4 The Objection That It Is 'Outside Economics' Also Misses the Issue

The objection that SBM is not really economics but only a general theory of preconditions also appears with some force. It raises a boundary question: does this claim belong inside economics? Yet this objection too does not directly deny SBM's central thesis. To say that the claim lies outside economics, one would first have to show that the conditions for the constitution of agents, survivability, continuation, and sustainable participation do not affect the existence, scope, market operation, or aggregate outcomes of economic activity.

SBM emphasizes precisely that these are internal conditions of economic activity. If demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics acquire meaning only on the presupposition that agents and organizations are capable of continuation, then the conditions for the constitution of agents cannot be pushed outside economics. Thus, while the objection that SBM is merely an external general theory is meaningful as a question of disciplinary boundary, it does not deny the priority of those conditions within economic theory itself.

4.5 The Objection That It Is 'Incomplete' Is a Qualification, Not a Refutation

The objection that SBM is still incomplete and does not yet fully provide firm theory, game theory, welfare theory, policy theory, empirical operationalization, or domain-specific formalization must be treated more carefully than the others. It contains an important qualification concerning how the scope of the research program should be described. SBM has already presented a basic skeleton and an ordering principle, but it still leaves many parts undeveloped as a comprehensive alternative system. In that sense, the warning that it is premature to speak of a fully completed new system has a justified side.

Yet this qualification, too, does not deny the central thesis itself. A theory's being incomplete does not mean that its claim about order is mistaken. What incompleteness indicates is rather a matter of developmental

stage: what has already been achieved and what remains to be done. Thus this objection imposes an important limit on how SBM should be described, but it does not undermine the first-principle claim itself.

4.6 Concluding Remarks

This chapter has shown that many of the major objections do not directly overturn SBM's central thesis. The reason is that they mainly address other levels of issue - representability, subsumability, novelty, disciplinary positioning, and completeness. The central issue therefore remains the problem of theoretical order: what should be placed first in theory. The next chapter makes this explicit as the distinction between representability and first-principle status.

Chapter 5. The Distinction Between Representability and First-Principle Status

This chapter distinguishes representability from first-principle status and shows that the difference between SBM and standard theory lies not in whether a given phenomenon can be formally described, but in what is taken as the starting point of theory. Even within standard theory, phenomena akin to non-survival, breakdown, inability to continue, and inability to participate can be represented to some degree. But that does not mean that utility maximization or profit maximization is the first principle for explaining them. The issue is not what can be written, but what gives theoretical meaning to other concepts prior to them.

5.1 Representability Does Not Determine Theoretical Order

Standard theory is formally flexible. Phenomena akin to minimum survival conditions, severe distress, breakdown, exit, and inability to participate can, to some extent, be represented inside existing optimization problems as minimum-consumption constraints, borrowing constraints, strong penalties, state-dependent utility, and corner solutions. Hence the observation that part of what SBM says can also be written within standard theory cannot be denied as a formal matter.

But what follows from this observation is only that standard theory can describe those phenomena. It does not follow that standard theory provides the correct starting point for explaining them. Representability means that a phenomenon can be described within an existing formalism. First-principle status, by contrast, concerns which conditions must be satisfied in advance for other concepts to have theoretical meaning. The latter does not follow from the former.

This distinction is decisive. Even if minimum survival conditions can be written as constraints, if those conditions determine the very existence of the choice set, then what is explanatorily prior is not the constraint but the conditions for the constitution of agents. The question of which option yields the highest utility among

available alternatives becomes meaningful only on the prior presupposition that the agent remains within the survivable region and possesses a meaningful action set. The difference between the two theories therefore lies not in whether minimum survival conditions can be represented, but in where theory begins.

5.2 Even If the Same State of Affairs Can Be Written, Its Theoretical Status Need Not Be the Same

More important still is that, even if the same state of affairs can be represented mathematically, its theoretical status need not be the same. It may be possible to write a survival floor as one constraint within standard theory. But if satisfaction of that constraint determines the continuation and participation of the agent, and even the very existence of the choice problem, then that condition is not a later auxiliary condition but a prior condition of theory.

SBM therefore does not propose one further condition to be added to standard theory. Rather, it first asks under what conditions the constraint set and the choice set have meaning at all. In this sense, even if two theories can describe the same phenomenon, it does not follow that they adopt the same theoretical order.

5.3 What Is a First Principle?

A first principle is not merely the symbol or equation that is placed first in an analysis. It is a condition that must be satisfied in advance for other concepts to possess theoretical meaning. On SBM's view, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation are such conditions. Optimization, equilibrium, price adjustment, and aggregate consistency acquire meaning only after those conditions are met. Thus, the fact that optimization is a powerful analytical tool must be distinguished from the claim that optimization is a first principle.

If this point is missed, one is led to the misunderstanding that the flexibility of standard theory somehow guarantees the correctness of its theoretical order. In reality, a flexible formalism merely allows many things to be written; it does not automatically decide what should come first. Theoretical order is determined by which conditions, in explanatory terms, give other concepts their conditions of possibility.

5.4 The Difference Between SBM and Standard Theory

From this it follows that the difference between SBM and standard theory does not lie in which can describe more phenomena. The difference lies in what is treated as the starting point of theory. Standard theory begins from already constituted agents maximizing objective functions under given constraints. SBM, by contrast, first asks whether those agents are constituted at all, whether they are survivable, whether they possess a basically feasible action set, whether continuation is possible, and whether sustainable participation is possible.

The relation between SBM and standard theory therefore cannot be adequately captured by the simple dichotomy of subsumption or exclusion. It is more appropriately understood as a relation between a theory of prior conditions and a conditional subordinate theory. Standard theory may still be valid, but only within domains where the prior conditions have already been satisfied. In this sense, SBM does not abolish standard theory wholesale; it repositions its scope of validity and theoretical order.

5.5 Concluding Remarks

This chapter distinguished representability from first-principle status and argued that the fact that certain threshold phenomena can be described within standard theory does not mean that optimization or equilibrium is the correct starting point of theory. The issue is not what can be written, but what gives theoretical meaning to other concepts before them. The difference between SBM and standard theory therefore lies not in representability but in theoretical order. The next chapter develops this point further by positioning SBM as a theory of the conditions for the constitution of agents and clarifying its character as a resetting of the domain.

Chapter 6. Not an Added Constraint but the Conditions for the Constitution of Agents

As shown in the previous chapter, representability does not determine first-principle status. The next question, therefore, is whether SBM can be understood as a mere added constraint on standard theory, or whether it should be understood as a theory that antecedently specifies the conditions for the constitution of agents. The claim of this chapter is clear: SBM is not an auxiliary theory that appends one further constraint to an existing optimization problem. Rather, it is a theory that determines prior to optimization whether agents are constituted at all, survivable, basically feasible, capable of continuation, and able to participate sustainably. In this sense, what SBM does is not a local correction of the feasible set but a resetting of the very domain of theory.

6.1 The Basic Structure of Standard Theory

The basic structure of standard theory is well known. Agents such as households and firms are given from the outset. Households possess choice sets of consumption bundles, firms possess choice sets of production plans, and under given constraints both maximize utility or profit. Within this structure, the existence of the agent, the feasibility of action, the possibility of participation, and the possibility of continuation usually lie outside the starting point of analysis. Of course, constraints can be made increasingly complex within standard theory. Budget constraints, borrowing constraints, trading constraints, information constraints, policy constraints, and many others may be added. But the underlying premise remains that a subject who chooses under constraints has already been constituted.

Within this structure, to add a constraint means to presuppose an existing agent and an existing choice set and then either shrink the set of feasible choices or add a correction term to the objective function. On this added-constraint understanding, the core of theory remains optimization. Whether constraints become tighter

or looser, the starting point of theory remains the same: an already existing agent chooses within them. Here lies the fundamental difference from SBM.

6.2 The Basic Structure of SBM

SBM differs from this. In SBM, the agent is not placed from the outset as a stably given entity. The issue begins rather from whether agents and organizations are constituted at all as theoretically meaningful units, whether they can move into the next period, whether they can execute action, and whether they can participate in exchange, production, and institutional use. The integrated foundational paper presented the order of constitutive conditions, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and only thereafter optimization. What this order means is that agents are not simply given, but can operate only within prior conditions.

Accordingly, in SBM the order of questioning is reversed. Standard theory presupposes that the agent exists and asks how that agent behaves under constraints. SBM first asks whether the agent can exist, whether the action set has meaning, and whether the unit lies within the domain of continuation; only then does it ask about choice, optimization, equilibrium, and aggregation. In this sense, SBM is not a theory of constraints, but a theory of the conditions under which the theoretical object itself is constituted. Constraints limit an agent's options, whereas the conditions for the constitution of agents determine whether the agent and its options exist in theory at all. The two are not the same.

6.3 The Difference Between 'Adding a Constraint' and 'Conditions for the Constitution of Agents'

This difference is clear even in more formal terms. On the added-constraint understanding, an agent and an action set are first given, and conditions are then appended within them. If, for example, one adds a minimum-consumption condition, this narrows the feasible set of an already given choice problem. But even then the theoretical focus remains on which choice is optimal. On the conditions-of-constitution understanding, by contrast, what is asked first is whether the agent is a theoretically meaningful unit at all. If the conditions of constitution are broken, then the optimization problem itself is no longer the proper starting point. The issue shifts from 'which is optimal?' to 'what is possible at all?' and 'how can operability be restored?'

The integrated foundational paper formulated this by saying that survival maintenance and breakdown avoidance precede utility maximization. This does not merely mean assigning high weight to survival inside a utility function. Rather, it means that where survivability is lost, what comes before comparisons internal to the utility function is whether the subject can still count as a theoretical agent of action. In situations where survival conditions are broken, utility maximization may still be writable, but it no longer carries explanatory centrality. Survival conditions are therefore not just one more constraint added within standard theory; they are conditions that antecedently determine the very operability of standard theory.

6.4 Resetting the Domain

That SBM is not a theory of added constraints but a theory of the conditions for the constitution of agents becomes even clearer at the level of domain. As the special-cases paper showed, in demand-supply theory demand and supply have theoretical meaning not over the nominal set of agents as such, but only over the effective set of agents that satisfy constitution, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation. In general equilibrium theory as well, excess demand and equilibrium conditions possess explanatory legitimacy only over the effective set of participants rather than the nominal participant set. In macroeconomic theory, too, it is presupposed that households, firms, and institutions remain within the domain of continuation.

What matters here is that SBM does not add one more condition within a pre-given domain; it first determines on what domain theory operates. This is decisive. On the added-constraint view, the domain is given first and the feasible set is then adjusted within it. In SBM, by contrast, the domain itself is selected by prior conditions. SBM's role is therefore not merely to reduce the degrees of freedom of choice, but to decide in advance who can still count as a theoretical object and in what region later theory acquires meaning. In this sense, SBM is not a theory of constraints but a theory of resetting the domain.

6.5 The Conditions for the Constitution of Agents Are Not Exogenous Add-ons

Another reason the added-constraint interpretation is insufficient is that conditions such as survivability, continuation, and participation are not merely exogenous auxiliary conditions but internal presuppositions of economic activity itself. If agents break down, firms become unable to continue, access to institutions is severed, and market participation becomes impossible, then price adjustment, equilibrium conditions, and policy transmission cannot operate as such. As the special-cases paper argues, demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics are each valid only as lower-order theories within domains where these basic conditions still hold. It is therefore mistaken to regard the conditions for the constitution of agents as exogenous constraints added from outside theory. They are, rather, internal prior conditions for standard theory's concepts to have meaning.

If this point is missed, SBM can appear to be merely a pessimistic extra condition. In reality, however, what SBM does is to make visible what standard theory has implicitly presupposed and to render the order of theory explicit. As the integrated foundational paper repeatedly emphasizes, SBM delineates the operative region on which standard theory relies by making explicit the branching between regions in which agents can be constituted and regions moving toward breakdown. The conditions for the constitution of agents are therefore not exogenous additions but an immanent foundation that determines the conditions under which standard theory can operate.

6.6 The Relation to Standard Theory

From this, the relation between SBM and standard theory can be stated more accurately. SBM is neither a rival theory wholly external to standard theory nor merely one variant or auxiliary hypothesis within it. More appropriately, SBM is a foundational theory that antecedently specifies the domain in which standard theory can hold, while standard theory is a lower-order theory valid in those situations where the foundational conditions are stably satisfied. As the integrated foundational paper emphasizes, the issue is not whether mainstream theory can write the phenomena, but what comes first. And as the special-cases paper shows,

demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics are repositioned as local adjustment, systemic adjustment, and aggregate adjustment, respectively. Their relation should therefore be understood not as an added-constraint model but as one between a theory of prior conditions and a conditional subordinate theory.

Seen in this way, the objection that 'SBM merely adds a constraint' notices only a certain formal resemblance and fails to capture the difference in theoretical position. Even if superficially similar equations can be written, if what counts as the first question of theory and on what domain theory operates are different, then the result is not a mere parameter adjustment or added constraint. SBM's originality lies precisely in this reordering.

6.7 Concluding Remarks

This chapter has shown why it is insufficient to regard SBM as merely adding one condition to standard theory. The basic structure of standard theory is that already constituted agents choose within given constraints. By contrast, the basic structure of SBM asks first whether the agent is constituted at all, survivable, basically feasible, and capable of continuation. SBM's role is therefore not to modify an existing choice problem, but to reset the very domain - the set of agents, actions, and participants - on which later theory has meaning. In this sense, SBM is not an added constraint, but a theory of the conditions for the constitution of agents. The next chapter, building on this point, organizes the sense in which standard theory remains conditionally valid and connects this with the reclassification of demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics.

Chapter 7. The Conditional Validity of Standard Theory

The previous chapter showed that SBM is not an additional condition imposed on standard theory, but a theory that antecedently specifies the conditions for the constitution of agents, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation. If that is so, the next question is clear: what position should standard theory occupy? If SBM is valid, is standard theory wholly denied, or does it remain valid within a limited range? The claim of this chapter is the latter. Standard theory is not discarded, but its range of validity and order are changed. It may still be valid within domains where agents and organizations remain operative. But that validity must be understood not as universal first-principle status, but as that of a conditional lower-order theory operating only within domains selected by prior conditions.

7.1 Not Denial but Repositioning

In debate over SBM, the issue is often framed as a choice between denying standard theory and preserving it. But this dichotomy is inappropriate. As the integrated foundational paper makes clear, SBM does not claim that standard theory is simply wrong. The issue is rather that standard theory has misconstrued what it presupposes, where it is valid, and what is prior to it. The significance of SBM therefore lies not in expelling standard theory but in repositioning it. Standard theory remains, but it is moved from the beginning of theory to a lower level.

This is also consistent with the conclusion of the special-cases paper. There, demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics are not said to be destroyed but to be reclassified. They may still be useful as theories of local market adjustment, systemic adjustment, and aggregate adjustment, but they are not the first theory of economics. Only where the prior layer of the constitution of agents, survival safety, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation has already been secured do they operate in the usual sense. Standard theory is therefore not rejected, but moved downward.

7.2 What Conditional Validity Means

Conditional validity here does not mean merely that a theory 'sometimes works.' It means that for a theory to be valid, specific prior conditions must already have been satisfied, and once those conditions break down the explanatory force of the theory's central concepts also declines. For standard theory, those prior conditions are that agents and organizations are constituted, survivable, basically feasible, capable of continuation, and capable of sustainable participation in exchange, production, and institutional use.

In this sense, the validity of standard theory depends not only on environmental stability or the existence of markets, but on the agent population that forms its theoretical object being in an operative state. If households are already in severe destabilization, firms are approaching inability to continue, and access to institutions is deteriorating, then demand functions, supply functions, equilibrium conditions, and aggregate consistency may still be writable, but their explanatory centrality declines. What becomes more prior is not how efficiently things are allocated, but who can still participate, which units remain in the domain of continuation, and where cascades of breakdown begin. The validity of standard theory is thus conditioned by the stability of prior conditions.

7.3 The Conditional Validity of Demand-Supply Theory

This can be seen most clearly in demand-supply theory. In standard demand-supply theory, households form demand, firms form supply, and prices adjust between them. But as the special-cases paper shows, this structure has meaning only when households satisfy the constitutive conditions, survivability, basic feasibility, and sustainable participation, and when firms maintain continuation of operation, feasibility, and sustainable participation. Demand and supply are therefore not universally given from the start; they are defined only within a set of agents that has already passed prior selection.

Demand-supply theory is therefore not invalid, but conditionally valid as a theory of local market adjustment. In relatively stable market domains, demand and supply curves may still serve as useful summaries. But their validity holds only when the conditions for the constitution of agents and participation have already

been secured. Where agents are approaching inability to continue and the effective sets of demanders and suppliers are shrinking, a demand-supply diagram may still be drawable, but it no longer describes the most prior structure. Demand-supply theory is thus locally and conditionally valid.

7.4 The Conditional Validity of General Equilibrium Theory

The same is true of general equilibrium theory. General equilibrium theory is a higher-order integrated theory than demand-supply theory, since it deals with the systematic consistency among many markets, many households, and many firms. But for that consistency to have meaning, the agents entering the equilibrium problem must already be theoretically meaningful participants. As the special-cases paper makes explicit, the object of general equilibrium theory is not the nominal set of participants as such, but the effective set of participants that satisfies constitution, survivability, safety, feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation. Equilibrium conditions have explanatory legitimacy only over this selected set of participants.

In this sense, general equilibrium theory is conditionally valid as a theory of systemic adjustment. The picture in which many markets are mutually interconnected and rendered consistent through prices remains effective only so long as the domain of operative participants is maintained. Where that effective participant set itself is shrinking and it becomes unstable who still remains inside the system of markets, the equilibrium problem recedes into the background. In such situations, what comes prior to the consistency of the price vector is the question of which agents still remain inside the market system at all. The validity of general equilibrium theory is therefore limited to the interior of the domain of selected participants.

7.5 The Conditional Validity of Macroeconomics

Macroeconomics should likewise be understood as a conditional lower-order theory. Standard macroeconomics is organized around aggregate variables such as consumption, investment, employment, prices, financial conditions, and policy effects. But as the special-cases paper shows, before such aggregates have meaning, the base populations of households, firms, and institutions must themselves still be capable of continuation and mutual interconnection. What becomes prior are the distribution of continuation,

destabilization, and termination; aggregate vulnerability; and the propagation of instability. Aggregate consistency and equilibrium paths cannot be the first object.

Macroeconomics is therefore conditionally valid as a theory of aggregate adjustment. In relatively stable economic situations it remains useful to grasp the interaction of consumption, investment, employment, prices, monetary policy, and fiscal policy at the aggregate level. But where the continuation of households, firms, and institutions is being eroded and instability is spreading across them, aggregate regularities themselves become derivative. The first issue is then not the path of aggregates, but whether the underlying units that carry those aggregates remain operative. Macroeconomics too is therefore valid only on a conditional basis.

7.6 Conditional Validity and the Status of Lower-Order Theory

From this the position of standard theory becomes clear. Demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics are not meaningless. On the contrary, each remains important as a theory of local market adjustment, systemic adjustment, and aggregate adjustment. But that importance does not guarantee the status of a universal first principle. Their correct status is that of conditional lower-order theories that operate only within regions where prior conditions have already been secured.

This understanding has two advantages. First, it allows us not to deny the analytical achievements of standard theory unnecessarily. Second, it still makes clear the need to reorder the starting point of economic theory. That standard theory is effective is different from its being what should come first. This is precisely the distinction SBM insists on.

7.7 Concluding Remarks

This chapter has shown that standard theory is not denied wholesale, but repositioned as a conditionally valid lower-order theory. Demand-supply theory remains valid as a theory of local market adjustment, general equilibrium theory as a theory of systemic adjustment, and macroeconomics as a theory of aggregate adjustment. But all of them are valid only after the prior conditions of constitution, survivability, basic

feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation have been secured. The significance of SBM therefore lies not in discarding standard theory, but in reorganizing its order and scope of validity.

Chapter 8. SBM as a Research Program

SBM positions the conditions for the constitution of agents, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation as conditions prior to optimization and equilibrium. If this theoretical repositioning is accepted, the next question is how SBM itself should be understood. This chapter argues that SBM is best understood not as a completed closed system, but as a research program with a clear central core and a clear direction of development.

8.1 What Has Already Been Achieved

The first achievement of SBM is the explicit statement of theoretical order. Rather than placing the starting point of economic theory in optimization and equilibrium, SBM replaces it with the order of the conditions for the constitution of agents, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, sustainable participation, and only then optimization. This is not a mere change of wording, but a structural reordering of what comes first in theory.

Second, SBM provides a framework that does not deny standard theory wholesale, but repositions its valid range as that of a conditional lower-order theory dependent on prior conditions. Demand-supply theory is repositioned as a theory of local market adjustment, general equilibrium theory as a theory of systemic adjustment, and macroeconomics as a theory of aggregate adjustment. This is one of the major achievements already made.

Third, SBM offers a perspective that reorganizes demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics as subordinate sequences dependent on the prior layer constituted by the continuation of agents and organizations. This is not merely an abstract declaration. It is an attempt to redescribe economic theory as a whole in terms of prior layers of conditions and adjustment theories operating on top of them.

Fourth, SBM already possesses a certain skeleton at the level of theoretical content itself. The foundational order centered on the constitution of agents, the dynamics of survival, breakdown, continuation, destabilization, and termination, and the reorganization of goods and conditions of participation together form not fragmented ideas but an interconnected central core. In this sense, SBM has already reached the stage of a general theory with a clear nucleus.

8.2 Tasks for Future Development

At the same time, the tasks that remain unfinished in SBM are also clear. First, the reformulations of demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics need to be developed in more rigorous mathematical and conceptual form. This paper presents the principle by which they are repositioned, but to reconstruct each theory under the prior conditions of SBM remains a further task.

Second, the scope of SBM needs to be extended to firm theory, game theory, welfare theory, and policy theory, and its range and limits need to be shown concretely. In particular, in domains such as strategic interaction, institutional design, policy evaluation, and social welfare, it remains to be shown what changes when the conditions for the constitution of agents are incorporated as prior conditions.

Third, concepts such as survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation need to be operationalized in forms connectable to empirical and institutional analysis. For SBM to develop further as a theory, it requires not only conceptual clarification but also observable indicators, institutional conditions, and possible empirical correspondences.

Fourth, the problem of domain-specific formalization remains. SBM presents an ordering principle as a general theory, but how that principle should be translated into mathematical form is not uniform across domains. At the levels of households, firms, finance, markets, states, and institutions, it remains to be specified how the conditions for the constitution of agents should be formulated and how they connect to later theory.

8.3 The Meaning of Incompleteness

Thus SBM still contains many unfinished parts. But this incompleteness does not mean that the theory is valueless or has failed. What matters instead is distinguishing what has already been achieved from what has not. Incompleteness means not that SBM is a completed total replacement system, but that its development remains open.

This point is important. There is a difference between an unfinished theory whose central core is itself vague and an unfinished theory whose central core is clear but whose development is still ongoing. SBM clearly belongs to the latter. The priority of the conditions for the constitution of agents over optimization, and the positioning of survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation as prior conditions, have already been stated clearly. What remains open is the further development built upon that core.

8.4 Positioning It as a Research Program

From this it follows that the most appropriate understanding of SBM is not as a completed closed system but as both a general theory of economic prior conditions and a research program with a clear central core and a clear direction of development. As a research program, SBM first provides the basic order; next it reorganizes the scope of validity of standard theory; and then it opens the way for lower-order developments into individual domains.

This positioning is also useful when considering the relation to mainstream theory. If SBM were presented as a closed rival system, the mainstream would tend to view it as a choice between total acceptance and total rejection. But if SBM is presented as a research program, evaluation can proceed in a more differentiated way: whether the ordering thesis is sound, whether the prior conditions are properly specified, and whether the lower-order developments are successful. This is a more accurate way to locate the current stage of SBM.

8.5 Concluding Remarks

This chapter positioned SBM as a research program. SBM has already achieved important results: explicit statement of theoretical order, prioritization of the conditions for the constitution of agents, reclassification of

the three core theories of standard theory, and presentation of a basic dynamic and layered structure. At the same time, firm theory, game theory, welfare theory, policy theory, empirical operationalization, and domain-specific formalization remain unfinished. SBM should therefore be understood neither as an empty idea nor as a completed total system, but as a research program with an already established core and an open line of development.

Chapter 9. Conclusion

The purpose of this paper has been to organize the main criticisms expected against the Survival-Breakdown Model (SBM), to show why many of them do not amount to decisive objections overturning its central thesis, and to clarify the relation between SBM and standard economic theory.

First, representability and first-principle status must be distinguished.

Minimum survival conditions, breakdown, inability to continue, and inability to participate can, to some degree, be represented within standard theory as minimum-consumption constraints, borrowing constraints, penalty terms, state-dependent utility, and corner solutions. But that does not mean that utility maximization or profit maximization is the first principle for explaining such phenomena. The issue is not what can be written, but what gives theoretical meaning to other concepts prior to them.

Second, SBM is not a mere added constraint, but a theory that antecedently specifies the conditions for the constitution of agents.

What SBM asks is not whether one can add a severe constraint inside an existing optimization problem. It asks whether the agent is constituted at all, survivable, basically feasible, capable of continuation, and capable of sustainable participation. Thus SBM does not merely modify a given feasible set; it resets the very domain on which later theory operates.

Third, standard theory is not denied wholesale, but repositioned as a conditional lower-order theory. Demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics may each remain valid as theories of local market adjustment, systemic adjustment, and aggregate adjustment. But their validity holds only after constitution, survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation have been secured. Their theoretical status must therefore be understood as conditional and domain-limited.

Fourth, SBM should be understood not as a completed closed system but as a research program with an established central core.

SBM has already achieved the status of a general theory in the sense that it has stated a theoretical order, prioritized the conditions for the constitution of agents, repositioned the three core theories of standard theory, and presented a basic layered structure and dynamic. But many lower-order developments remain open, and it should therefore be understood as a research program rather than a finished total system.

Accordingly, the relation between SBM and standard theory should be understood not through the simple dichotomy of subsumption or exclusion, but as one between a theory of prior conditions and a conditional subordinate theory. Standard theory acquires meaning only within domains where agents and organizations are constituted, basically feasible, capable of continuation, and capable of sustainable participation. SBM's significance lies in making those prior conditions explicit and in reorganizing the starting point of theory.

Finally, the conclusion of this paper is not to fix SBM as a completed system, but to clarify its central thesis and theoretical position. The future tasks are therefore also clear. First, demand-supply theory, general equilibrium theory, and macroeconomics must be reconstructed more fully under the priority of the conditions for the constitution of agents and continuation. Second, the program must be extended to domains such as firm theory, game theory, welfare theory, and policy theory. Third, the concepts of survivability, basic feasibility, continuation, and sustainable participation must be operationalized for empirical and institutional analysis. In this sense, SBM should be understood as a program that has already established its theoretical nucleus and now opens onto further systematic development.

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